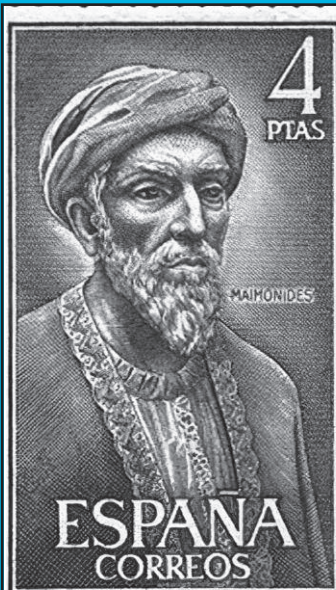


THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR



Aiding Needy
Holocaust Survivors



PS NE DE MONEDA Y TIMBRE



15781

THE BLUE CARD is a charitable organization that has been aiding Holocaust survivors since 1934. It is dedicated to the support of European Jewish survivors and their descendants in this country, who still suffer from the aftereffects of Nazi persecution, are sick or emotionally unstable, have been unable to achieve economic independence, or have lost it through sickness or old age; in many cases the Holocaust has deprived them of family. The Blue Card's activities aren't duplicated by any other Jewish welfare agencies. During the year 2019, The Blue Card distributed nearly \$2.7 million. This brings the grant total since The Blue Card's inception to over \$40 million.

THE BLUE CARD continues to receive four-star ratings from Charity Navigator, a distinction awarded to only four percent of all charities. The Blue Card is Better Business Bureau (BBB) accredited.

THE BLUE CARD mirrors the social conscience of our community. We hope it will be important to you, and that you will remember it in your last will. Your contribution is fully tax deductible.

THE BLUE CARD has been publishing this calendar for its friends and friends-to-be for more than 50 years in order to remind them, throughout the year, that there is an organization which is always ready to render assistance to our neediest.

PLEASE SEE the inside back cover of this calendar for more information about The Blue Card.

A copy of the most recent financial report may be obtained from The Blue Card, Inc., 171 Madison Ave. Suite 1405, New York, NY 10016.

Front cover: Postage stamps from Spain and Israel depicting Moses Maimonides.

Back cover: Dr. Albert Sabin administering a dose of polio vaccine to a child, 1963.

THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR

For 5781 (2020-2021 C.E.)

ITS THEME:

JEWISH CONTRIBUTIONS TO MEDICINE

Published by

THE BLUE CARD, Inc.®

Serving needy Jewish Holocaust survivors since 1939

171 Madison Ave., Suite 1405

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5781

INTRODUCTION

These words are being written amid a pandemic unlike anything in living memory, one in which we look to medical science to find treatments and ultimately a secure means of prevention. So it's natural for our thoughts to turn to the history of science and medicine — and one thing that's striking is the prominent role played over the centuries by Jewish doctors and medical researchers.

The practice of medicine is deeply ingrained in Jewish culture and history (and manifested in “Jewish doctor” jokes!). Since its earliest days, Judaism has supported the idea of human intervention to cure sickness. Elliot N. Dorff, in a scholarly article about Jewish traditions and healthcare decisions, writes: “Judaism’s positions on issues in health care stem from three of its underlying principles: that the body belongs to God; that the body is integrated into the entire human person and, as such, is morally neutral, its moral valence being determined by how we use our physical abilities; and that human beings have both the permission and the obligation to heal.” The Bible and the Talmud both have many references to healing and to physicians, and they give injunctions to heal oneself and others.

Edward C. Halperin quotes Moses Maimonides, writing in the 12th century, as equating the acquisition of medical knowledge with becoming closer to God. Maimonides wrote: “The study of medicine has a very great influence on the acquisition of the virtues and of the knowledge of God, as far as on the attainment of true spiritual happiness. Therefore, its study and acquisition are preeminently important religious activities.”

The Middle Ages saw many Jews practicing medicine throughout the diaspora, with some rising to positions of great prominence — not only within their Jewish communities, but with some as doctors to kings and popes. With the coming of the Age of Enlightenment, there was a gradual though very uneven loosening of restrictions on Jews, and Jewish students started being allowed to enter universities and medical schools more widely than before. In

countries such as Germany and Austria where Jews participated to a significant degree in the secular culture, they made great inroads into the medical field. This was true in virtually every field, and particularly the case for psychoanalysis, which was dominated in its early years by Jewish theorists and practitioners.

The doctor and author Michael Nevins quotes Louis Brandeis as saying this about Jewish immigrants to the United States: “The qualities of scholarship have not come to us by accident; they were developed by 3,000 years of civilization and nearly 2,000 years of persecutions; through our religion and spiritual life; through our traditions; and through the social and political condition under which our ancestors lived.”

This drive to learn, work and succeed has manifested itself to a great degree in the medical field. To date, 54 of the 223 winners of the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine — 24% — have been Jewish, whereas Jews comprise some 0.2% of the world’s population and about 1.8% of the population of the United States.

In this year’s Blue Card calendar, we take a very incomplete look at Jewish contributions in the medical field. This is a vast topic with a vast literature, and time and space allow us only to scratch the surface. Even so, what we see is enormously impressive. Jewish doctors and scientists have been responsible for groundbreaking advances that have touched all of us.

— Ralph Hammelbacher

This year’s edition was edited by Ralph Hammelbacher. Hella Hammelbacher created the original design, which was ably realized by Jacqueline Enrique.



Maimonides.

Moses ben Maimon (1138-1204), better known today as **Maimonides** or by the acronym Rambam, was born in Córdoba, Spain, but his family chose exile to Morocco after the Almohad conquest in 1148. After living for a time in Israel, he settled in what is today Cairo, Egypt.

A polymath, Maimonides is best remembered for his religious and philosophical writings, notably the 14-volume *Mishneh Torah* and the *Guide for the Perplexed*. But he was also known as a great physician who treated both Jews and non-Jews, and some of the methods he used are incorporated into present-day medical practice. He employed what we would today call a holistic approach to medicine, advocating treating the patient and not just the disease. He viewed maintaining a healthy lifestyle as a moral obligation, and —

in contrast to the teachings of other religions at the time — said that medicine is not in conflict with religion, but rather that humans are obligated to act as God's agents.

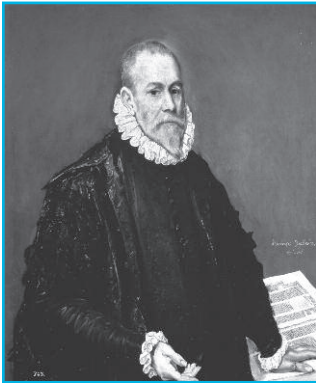
Things important to good health included clean air, good diet, getting exercise and maintaining control over the emotions — all things we would recognize as contemporary advice.

Maimonides viewed the study of medicine as a way to become closer to God: “When a person contemplates His great and wondrous works and creatures and from them obtains a glimpse of His wisdom which is incomparable and infinite, he will immediately love Him, praise Him, glorify Him, and long with an exceeding longing to know His great name...”

Elul 5780 - Tishri 5781

SEPTEMBER 2020

SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
		1	2	3	4	5
6	7 <i>Labor Day</i>	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18 <i>Erev Rosh Hashanah</i>	19 <i>Tishri 1 5781 Rosh Hashanah</i>
20 <i>Rosh Hashanah Second Day</i>	21	22	23	24	25	26
27 <i>Erev Yom Kippur</i>	28 <i>Yom Kippur</i>	29	30			



El Greco's Portrait of a Doctor, painted 1582-85, may be of Luis de Mercado. It hangs in the Prado Museum in Madrid.

Luis de Mercado, also known as Ludovicus Mercatus, was born into a Jewish family in León, Spain. Some sources give his year of birth as 1525, and others say he was more likely born in 1532. He studied at the University of Valladolid, receiving his doctorate in medicine in 1560. In 1572, he became professor of medicine at Valladolid, and in 1592 received the honor of being appointed principal doctor to King Felipe II. After Felipe II's death in 1598, he continued as doctor to Felipe III. He was put in charge of regulating all medical practice in Spain, and wrote the standards of practice and licensing.

Mercado's prolific writings were some of the most important in the history of medicine. *On the Condition of Women* dealt with gynecology, pregnancy, childbirth, breastfeeding and the full range of women's medicine. Mercado's *Opera Omnia* was truly a magnum opus. Published in four volumes, the last one posthumously, it covered most of the medical knowledge

that existed at the time. It included detailed discussions and analyses of anatomy and physiology, general pathologies, hygiene, fevers, the pulse, hereditary diseases, syphilis, pediatrics and many more topics.

Mercado's work not only formed the basis for medical study for generations, but also foresaw future developments in genetics and even the age of specialization in which we now live.

Tishri - Heshvan 5781

OCTOBER 2020

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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*Erev Succoth**Succoth 1st Day*

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*Succoth 2nd Day**Hoshana Rabba**Shemini Atzeret*

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*Simchat Torah**Columbus Day*

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Heshvan 1

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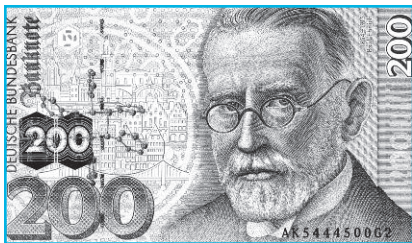
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Paul Ehrlich on the 200 Deutsche Mark note, issued by Germany until 2001.

Paul Ehrlich was born in 1854 in Strehlen in Silesia. In 1908, he became one of the first two Jewish winners of the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine.

Ehrlich grew up in a prominent family, and knew early on that he wanted to pursue a career in medical research; he became interested in the process of staining tissue for the purpose of studying its blood cells and other components. After studies in several universities, he received his doctorate in 1882 and

began work at the Charité, then and now a leading research institute.

Continuing his work on staining, Ehrlich saw that chemical reactions were taking place within cells, and that different cells responded differently to different dyes. This led him to the discovery that specially developed compounds, by binding to targeted cells, could selectively kill disease-carrying organisms while leaving healthy cells alone — the “magic bullet” that remains the goal of therapeutic treatments today. This was the foundation of chemotherapy. Ehrlich’s work differentiating different types of blood cells also laid the groundwork for the modern sciences of hematology, immunology, pharmacology and oncology.

Ehrlich’s discoveries had rapid practical results in the development of treatments for diphtheria, tetanus and syphilis, among others, and inspired work by generations of scientists. He continued his work, eventually at the institute he founded in Frankfurt, and died in 1915.

Heshvan - Kislev 5781

NOVEMBER 2020

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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Daylight Saving
Time Ends

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Kislev 1

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Thanksgiving

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August von Wassermann.

August von Wassermann was born in 1866 in Bamberg, Germany, into a wealthy family of bankers. Studying at the University of Erlangen and several other universities, he received his medical doctorate in 1888. In 1891, he began work at the Prussian Institute of Infectious Diseases (today the Robert Koch Institute) in Berlin.

It was a time of rapid advances in bacteriology and immunology, and at the institute Wassermann had access to a vast amount of research and the talents of a host of pioneering researchers. Drawing on the work of a number of them, including Paul Ehrlich, Wassermann and his colleagues Albert Neisser and Carl Bruch in 1906 developed an effective test for syphilis antibodies.

Within a few years, use of the Wassermann test, as it came to be known, had spread to many locations, and it made a huge difference to public health. At the end of the 19th century, syphilis was an enormous and widespread issue that caused death and disfigurement and was little controlled. After the advent of the Wassermann test and the development of a treatment by Ehrlich (and subsequently the introduction of penicillin), syphilis became much less of a threat.

The Wassermann test was extensively refined and remains in partial use to this day, although it has largely been supplanted by other tests.

SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
		1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10 <i>Hanukkah First Candle</i>	11	12
13	14	15	16 <i>Tevet 1</i>	17 <i>Hanukkah Eighth Candle</i>	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25 <i>Christmas Day</i>	26
27	28	29	30	31 <i>New Year's Eve</i>		



*Cedars-Sinai Medical Center
in Los Angeles.*

Edward C. Halperin wrote in the May 2012 issue of *Academic Medicine* about the history of Jewish hospitals in the United States, and this summary is based on his work.

The impulse to build Jewish hospitals in the U.S. began in the middle of the 19th century, and arose from several factors: the wish for Jews not to be a burden on the larger community; the desire to avoid attempts in other hospitals to “save” dying patients by converting them to Christianity; the imperative to provide rabbinical care and kosher food to patients; and as a way for Jewish medical professionals, who faced discrimination and restrictions elsewhere, to work.

The first American Jewish hospital was the Jewish Hospital Association of Cincinnati, opened in 1854. Jewish hospitals soon opened in a number of other major cities, and before long, most had opened their doors to people of all religions. Construction continued through the middle of the 20th century; Halperin calculates that they had combined beds of more than 25,000 and saw more than 3 million patients a year.

But with the decline in organized antisemitism, Jewish doctors and medical staff have been able to practice anywhere, and Jewish hospitals have been subject to the same economic pressures as hospitals everywhere. This has resulted in a great deal of consolidation, much of it with hospitals with no religious affiliation. While many institutions retain their Jewish names, most retain little or no organized involvement from the Jewish community. As Halperin writes, “They are institutions that succeeded so profoundly in abetting the success of the American Jewish community that they became unnecessary.”

Tevet - Shevat 5781

JANUARY 2021

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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New Year's Day

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Shevat 1

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*Martin Luther
King Jr. Day*

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Tu B'Shevat



Dr. Gisella Perl, a Romanian doctor who treated hundreds of prisoners at Auschwitz while herself an inmate.

In the early 20th century, Jewish women faced the same obstacles to practicing medicine as all women, along with the added barrier of antisemitism. Still, over the centuries Jewish women made enormous contributions as nurses and midwives, and a number became doctors. Cheryl Tallan, writing in the *Jewish Women's Archive*, notes that there were Jewish women doctors during the medieval period “in most of the countries of western and central Europe, i.e., Spain, France, Provence, Italy, Sicily, and especially in Germany.” She also found a record of one 15th-century female doctor in Poland, and believes there must have been more. Many of these doctors treated both male and female patients, Jewish and Gentile.

By the 20th century, there were many female Jewish doctors in central Europe. Harriet Pass Freidenreich, writing in *Contemporary Jewry*, found that Jewish women constituted about 20% of all female doctors in central Europe in the first part of the 1900s. In

Germany and Austria, many took advantage of the opening of universities to women, and despite the twin impediments of misogyny and antisemitism, many had successful medical careers prior to the coming of the Nazis.

Some Jewish women were able to provide medical assistance to fellow prisoners in concentration camps. And many who survived the Holocaust were able to continue successful medical careers in the countries to which they emigrated.

Shevat - Adar 5781

FEBRUARY 2021

SUNDAY

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TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

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Adar 1

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Valentine's Day

Presidents Day

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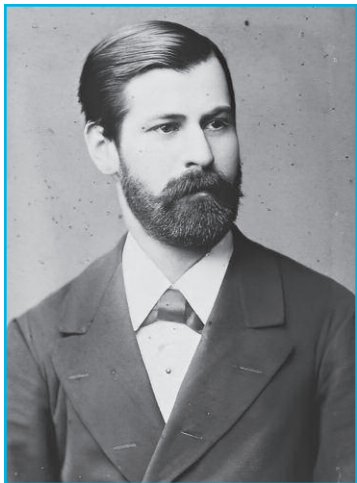
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Erev Purim

Purim

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Sigmund Freud about 1885.

Sigmund Freud (1856-1939) was the towering figure of the 19th and 20th centuries in the development of the science of the mind. Freud founded the practice of psychoanalysis, which is still key today to understanding human behavior and to treating people for the relief of mental ills.

Freud was born in Moravia but moved with his parents to Vienna at the age of 4, and spent most of his life there until his emigration to England in 1938 to escape the Nazis. After studies in Vienna and Paris, he began his practice in Vienna in 1886. In the ensuing years, he developed his theories, many of which remain controversial but which have elements that have been so widely accepted that they have entered the lexicon and remain in widespread use. He published *The Interpretation of Dreams* in 1900, introducing the idea that there is a subconscious which drives much of human behavior and which can be understood through talking therapy.

Freud wrote that human personalities are made up of the id, ego and superego. The id is the primitive, instinctive force that is responsible for basic desires such as sexual impulses and aggression. The ego, said Freud, is “that part of the id which has been modified by the direct influence of the external world,” which finds ways to channel the id’s impulses to achieve the id’s demands. And the superego is shaped by society and guides the ego in moral realms.

Adar - Nisan 5781

MARCH 2021

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

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Daylight Saving
Time Begins

Nisan 1

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Erev Passover

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Passover 1st Day

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Anna Freud.

Sigmund Freud believed human behavior was driven by libido —urges that are primarily sexual that begin at the earliest parts of infancy. This in turn takes part in stages: the oral stage, the anal stage, and then via the Oedipus complex, where a child develops feelings of attraction for a parent of the opposite sex.

Freud thought that the mind used a number of defense mechanisms to deal with conflicts. These include repression, or failing to deal with conflict on a conscious level by pushing it to the subconscious, and sublimation, which channels urges into art, work or other pursuits.

The clinical treatment that Freud developed, which he called psychoanalysis, remains in widespread use today. It typically consists of talk therapy, where the patient lies on a couch and speaks through free association to the earliest memories of his or her symptoms, fantasies and relationships. The analyst asks questions that facilitate the process. Over a period of time, with successful treatment symptoms are reduced and patients are cured.

Freud's work was contributed to and expanded by a host of brilliant people, many of whom were Jewish. Prominent among them were **Alfred Adler**, Freud's daughter **Anna Freud**, **Abraham Maslow**, **Erich Fromm** and **Noam Chomsky**, among many others.

Nisan - Iyar 5781

APRIL 2021

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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Good Friday

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Easter Sunday

Passover 8th Day

Yom Hashoah

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Iyar 1

*Israel
Independence
Day*

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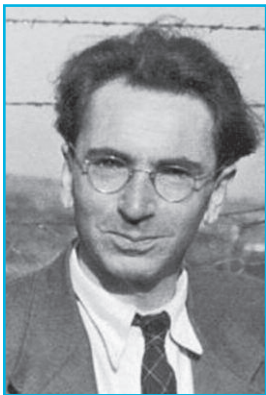
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Lag B'Omer



Viktor Frankl.

Viktor Frankl (1905-1997) studied neurology and psychiatry in his native Vienna, and by the mid-1920s he had already begun developing his theory, which he called logotherapy, that finding meaning in life was the central human force.

By the end of 1938, following the Nazi annexation of Austria, Frankl was no longer able to practice on non-Jewish patients. (He was able to save the lives of several Jewish patients by deliberately giving them false diagnoses so that they would not be euthanized.) After turning down the chance to immigrate to the United States so that he could remain with his parents, Frankl, his parents and wife were all deported — in Frankl's case, successively to Terezin, Auschwitz, Kaufering and Türkheim.

In 1946, following his liberation, he returned to Vienna and received the news of his wife's and parents' deaths in the camps. Frankl dictated his book, *Man's Search for Meaning*, in the span of nine days. Considered one of the most influential books ever written, *Man's Search for Meaning* draws on Frankl's and his fellow prisoners' experiences in the concentration camps to argue that "responsibleness [is] the very essence of human existence." He said: "We can discover this meaning in life in three different ways: (1) by creating a work or doing a deed; (2) by experiencing something or encountering someone; and (3) by the attitude we take toward unavoidable suffering." He observed that "man is ultimately self-determining," and that our own decisions determine how we behave.

Iyar - Sivan 5781

MAY 2021

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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Mother's Day

Sivan 1

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Erev Shavuot

Shavuot
1st Day

Shavuot
2nd Day

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Memorial
Day 31



Rita Levi-Montalcini in her lab in St. Louis in the early 1960s.

Rita Levi-Montalcini, an Italian doctor and researcher, became just the fourth female Nobel laureate in physiology or medicine when she won the prize in 1986. (She was also the second Jewish female Nobel Prize winner in that category, after Gerty Cori.) Levi-Montalcini's life story was remarkable.

Born in 1909 in Turin, Italy, she decided to attend the University of Turin medical school after the death of a friend. Her father was reluctant for her as a woman to attend university, but eventually acquiesced. After graduating with

high honors, she remained at the university to do research, but that was cut short in 1938, when Jews were no longer allowed to do professional work. She set up a laboratory in her home, and did the same in her place of hiding after her family fled to Florence during World War II.

In 1946, she accepted a research position at Washington University in St. Louis, and stayed there for decades, dividing her work there with research at a second laboratory that she established in Rome. Among her many contributions was the discovery of nerve growth factor, a substance released by tumors that causes the growth of nerve cells in places where they do not belong. This in turn led to greater understanding of many diseases. She shared the Nobel Prize for this work with **Stanley Cohen**, a colleague at Washington University in St. Louis.

In 2001, Levi-Montalcini was appointed Senator for Life in Italy, and she subsequently participated in Senate sessions. She died in 2012, at the age of 103.

Sivan - Tammuz 5781

JUNE 2021

SUNDAY

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TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

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Tammuz 1

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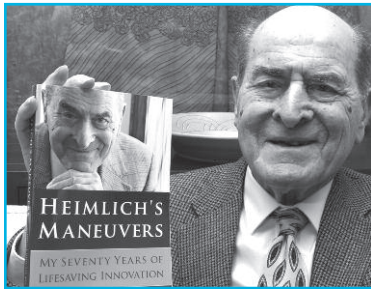
Father's Day

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Henry Heimlich at age 94, with his autobiography.

Henry Heimlich was born in Wilmington, Delaware in 1920, the grandson of immigrants from Hungary and Russia. He graduated from Cornell University and got his MD degree from Weill Cornell Medical College in 1943, at the age of 23. He then served with the U.S. Navy.

Heimlich is remembered for his invention of the chest drainage flutter valve and, most famously, for the development of the technique of abdominal thrusts that came to be known as the Heimlich Maneuver.

The flutter valve, or Heimlich valve, saved many lives during the Vietnam War. In chest wounds, it enables the drainage of blood and air from the chest cavity, enabling the lungs to inflate.

In 1974, he published his views on abdominal thrusts as a way to clear the trachea of a choking victim, and the technique became widely adopted, typically in combination with blows to the victim's back. It is credited with having saved countless lives.

Heimlich's reputation became somewhat clouded by his advocacy of a treatment called malariotherapy, infecting patients with malaria as a way to treat cancer, Lyme disease and HIV. This has been dismissed as dangerous and ineffective for its intended purpose.

He died in 2016 at the age of 96.

Tammuz - Av 5781

JULY 2021

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

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*Independence
Day*

Av 1

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Tisha B'Av

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Jonas Salk in the laboratory.

By the late 1940s and early 1950s, polio, caused by the poliovirus, was disabling about 35,000 people a year in the United States alone. Countless others who initially recovered from their symptoms would go on to experience renewed symptoms later in life.

Jonas Salk, the son of Russian-Jewish immigrants, was born in New York City in 1914 and became the developer of the first effective vaccine against poliomyelitis. He studied medicine at NYU, graduating in 1939, went to the University of Michigan in 1942 and then to the University of Pittsburgh in 1947. There, with funding from the organization that was later called the March of Dimes, he worked on developing a vaccine against polio.

Salk was a pioneer in proving that a vaccine made from a killed virus could be much safer than earlier vaccines made from attenuated viruses — the killed virus stimulated the body to produce antibodies without the risk of infecting the patient. Widespread trials began in the U.S. in 1954, and within a few years, the incidence of polio had been vastly reduced.

Salk refused to patent his discovery and never profited from it. In 1963, he founded the Salk Institute for Biological Studies in La Jolla, California, and spent the years before his death in 1995 working on vaccines for AIDS and other diseases.

Salk's rival **Albert Sabin** developed an oral polio vaccine made of attenuated virus that in the early 1960s largely supplanted the Salk vaccine. Sabin's vaccine has brought polio close to elimination worldwide. Like Salk, Sabin refused to patent or profit from his vaccine.

Av - Elul 5781

AUGUST 2021

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

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Elul 1

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Gertrude Elion at Burroughs Wellcome in the 1950s.

Gertrude Elion, born in New York City in 1918, was the daughter of Jewish immigrants from Lithuania and Russia. She recalled having “an insatiable thirst for knowledge” as a child. She was drawn to studying chemistry after her grandfather died of cancer, in the hope that she might one day help find a cure for the disease. As a female doing scientific research, she encountered many obstacles finding work, but the labor shortages caused by World War II helped her secure a position as a research chemist at the drug company Burroughs Wellcome, where she remained the rest of her career. (Even after her retirement, she continued to work full time.)

Elion pioneered the systematic, targeted design of drugs based on detailed knowledge of the pathogens the drugs were meant to combat, rather than relying largely on trial and error.

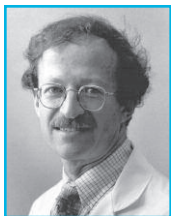
This approach yielded remarkable results. She and her colleagues developed a succession of impactful drugs including treatments for childhood leukemia, lupus, malaria, gout, arthritis and hepatitis, among others. She developed the antiviral drug acyclovir, still used today in the treatment of shingles, herpes and chicken pox, and the first immunosuppressants, which enable organ transplantation.

In 1988, she shared the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for her work. She died in 1999, after a rich life that included travel, photography, and a passion for opera.

Elul 5781 - Tishri 5782

SEPTEMBER 2021

SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
			1	2	3	4
5	6 <i>Labor Day</i> <i>Erev Rosh Hashanah</i>	7 <i>Tishri 1 5782 Rosh Hashanah</i>	8 <i>Rosh Hashanah Second Day</i>	9	10	11
12	13	14	15 <i>Erev Yom Kippur</i>	16 <i>Yom Kippur</i>	17	18
19	20 <i>Erev Succoth</i>	21 <i>Succoth 1st Day</i>	22 <i>Succoth 2nd Day</i>	23	24	25
26	27 <i>Hoshana Rabba</i>	28 <i>Shemini Atzeret</i>	29 <i>Simchat Torah</i>	30		



Harold Varmus.

Harold Varmus has combined varying careers as an accomplished medical researcher, as head of some of the most prestigious medical institutions in the U.S., and as a public intellectual serving on advisory boards for government organizations, nonprofits, and corporations.

Varmus was born on Long Island in 1939 to children of Jewish immigrants from Poland and Austria (his paternal grandmother died in the 1918 flu pandemic). After graduating from Amherst and obtaining a graduate degree, he pursued medical studies at Columbia. In 1970, he moved to San Francisco and began post-doctoral research with J. Michael Bishop at the University of California, San Francisco. They shared the 1989 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for their work identifying a family of genes which control the normal growth and division of cells. Their Nobel citation explained that “disturbances in one or some of these [genes] can lead to transformation of a normal cell into a tumor cell and result in cancer.” Over the decades, Varmus made many more discoveries in the field of genetics.

In 1993, Varmus was nominated for the directorship of the National Institutes of Health by President Clinton. His tenure, which lasted through 1999, was notable for many initiatives, a dramatic expansion of research, and increased funding. He left in order to become president and CEO of the Memorial Sloan-Kettering Cancer Center in New York City, and served there for more than ten years. President Obama then nominated him as director of the National Cancer Institute, where he served from 2010 until 2015, leaving to join the Weill Cornell Medical College faculty. Varmus has also served on a number of advisory panels, including that of the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation.

Tishri - Heshvan 5782

OCTOBER 2021

SUNDAY

MONDAY

TUESDAY

WEDNESDAY

THURSDAY

FRIDAY

SATURDAY

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Heshvan 1

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Columbus Day

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Established in Germany in 1934, The Blue Card's sole purpose was to provide financial assistance to Jews fleeing from that country's growing persecution. It was re-established in the United States in 1939, to continue aiding refugees escaping from the Nazi horror. Today, it is the only organization in the United States whose sole mission is to aid needy Holocaust survivors by providing cash assistance.

The Blue Card offers its invaluable help to Holocaust survivors through a variety of vital programs.

Description of The Blue Card's Programs

1. Emergency Cash Assistance Program: One-time grant assistance for emergency needs including:

- Housing and related costs such as late payments to prevent eviction or homelessness or shut off of utilities
- Emergency relocation

- Food purchases
- Medical and dental care, including medical equipment not otherwise covered by insurance
- Essential clothing and footwear
- Purchase and repair of essential major and minor appliances

2. Emergency Prevention Programs:

- Monthly Stipend – supports the most poverty-stricken survivors with monthly checks.
- Telephone Emergency Response System – provides the system to Holocaust survivors who do not have the financial resources to pay for installation, service and maintenance.

3. Health and Well-being Programs:

- Fighting Cancer Together – offers aid to survivors battling cancer. Assistance is available for transportation to appointments, medical co-pays, nutrition and emotional support.
- Vitamins – provides survivors with multivitamins, minerals and supplements, as well as liquid meals.
- Jewish Holiday – provides financial support for the High Holidays, Hanukkah and for Passover, giving survivors the financial means to have a happier holiday season.
- Mazel Tov Birthday – provides survivors with a card and a check on their birthday. These gifts mean a great deal to the many survivors who lost their entire families during the war.
- Summer Vacation – survivors are provided with handicapped-accessible accommodations, transportation, scheduled meals, and a well-planned itinerary, making the program structured, safe and group oriented.
- Bring a Smile – provides additional support to terminally ill Holocaust survivors. The program essentially grants survivors their final wish.

4. Educational and Outreach Programs:

- Person-Centered, Trauma-Informed Training for Dental and Medical professionals working with Holocaust survivors – provides sensitivity training to medical and dental profession working with Holocaust survivors.

- Nutrition Guidance - Educates Survivors on proper nutrition.
- Hospital Visitation - offers volunteer visits to hospitalized Holocaust survivors who need guidance and emotional support.

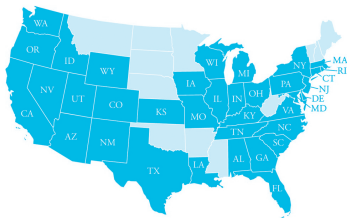
5. The Blue Card Tech Friendly Aging Programs:

- LIFTWARE Utensils - Liftware is an electronic stabilizing handle and a selection of attachments that include a soup spoon, everyday spoon, fork, and spork. Liftware Steady is designed to help people with hand tremor, which may be related to Parkinson's disease or essential tremor, eat more easily. Holocaust survivors suffering with Parkinson's Disease and other debilitating illnesses benefit tremendously from this special stabilizing unit.
- Mood Restore Light Box - Intelligent Light Therapy - A special, compact and portable, UV free unit provides much needed light therapy to Holocaust survivors. In addition to effectively treating Season Affective Disorders (SAD), the Mood Restore Light Box, improves visual clarity and color rendering, as well as offset season weather and climate changes, and helps support the circadian rhythm regulation. This light box works wonders for thousands of our lonely survivors especially those who are shut-ins and are home-bound during the colder winter days.

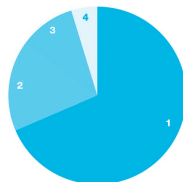
- Companion Pets - Companion pets bring comfort and happiness to the older population with interactive, cats and dogs that replicate the look, sounds and feel of real pets. Many studies have found that these pets have the ability to enhance one's well-being and quality of life through companionship.
- Uniper Cares Combating Social Isolation Program - We are pleased to announce that The Blue Card will strengthen its relationship with the Jewish Federations of North America (JFNA) and the Network of Jewish Human Service Agencies (NJHSA) by working together on a groundbreaking project which will utilize technology to address the challenging dynamic of senior isolation. The program will support home-bound Holocaust survivors and will utilize broadcast and video technology developed by Uniper Cares, a start-up company with roots in Israel. The Blue Card was selected along with a handful of other agencies from across the country to participate in this project. We are so grateful to work with the JFNA and the NJHSA in a new, creative capacity to provide this special support to survivors.

I.	Monthly Assistance Program	\$1,842,499
II.	Emergency Cash Assistance Program	\$453,271
III.	Telephone Emergency Response Program	\$265,507
IV	Supplemental Cash Assistance Program	\$125,704
Total		\$2,686,980

The Blue Card's Clients Across the United States



In 2019, The Blue Card distributed nearly \$2.7 million to destitute Holocaust survivors in the United States; below is the breakdown of that number.





THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR

5781

